[METRIC]
A-A-2778
September 06, 1995

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION
MARKER, TUBE TYPE, FINE, FELT TIP

This Commercial Item Description is approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration for use by all federal agencies. This document replaces Federal Specification GG-M-1130 which has been canceled.

1. **Scope:** This commercial item description covers pen sized-tube type, fine tip markers for use in freehand marking, writing, drawing, and identification marking on paper and porous surfaces.

2. **Salient Characteristics:**

2.1 The marker shall be a non-refillable type, designed to operate by capillary action. The marker shall be constructed to provide good protection against evaporation and leakage. The ink shall be water based, free from obnoxious odors, and shall be held within the marker by an absorbent material so that there are no free liquid within the marker.

2.2 The marker shall be equipped with a tight-fitting plastic or metal protective cap and the over-all length (with the cap in place) shall not be less than 130.0 mm (5.1 inches).

2.3 Metal, as may be used, shall be of a material and workmanship appropriate for the intended purpose. Such metal where used externally, shall be coated or plated to protect its finish.

2.4 The markers shall be furnished in the following colors; Black, Blue, Red, Green, Brown, Orange, Purple, and Yellow.

2.5 The marker barrel shall be made of plastic or metal or a combination of these materials. The barrel diameter shall not be less than 7.9 mm (0.310 inches), excluding tapered and recessed ends, and not more than 12.7 mm (.5 inches) and shall be constructed so that the ink will emerge only through the writing nib.

2.6 The writing nib may be of any material suitable for the intended purpose and it shall be permanently secured in position by an appropriate design feature. The marker shall write a minimum distance of 762m (2500 ft) when tested as specified in section (5).

"Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Engineering Branch, 26 Federal Plaza, New York, NY 10278".

FSC 7520

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2.7 The cap or body shall be colored, or have a colored marking to indicate the color of ink content. The surface of the marker and all components shall have a smooth, uniform appearance and shall be free from cold bonds, delaminations, porosity, warpage, cracks, checks, chips, rough or sharp edges, burrs, blisters, or scratches.

2.8 The manufacturer's name or trademark shall be exhibited on the marker. Placement of these permanent markings shall be at the option of the manufacturer, provided they are prominently displayed.

2.9 Shelf Life. The markers shall be able to meet all the requirements of this specification from the time of delivery to a minimum of 18 months in storage under normal storage conditions. Suppliers shall replace, without cost to the government, all markers failing to meet this requirement.

3. Regulatory Requirements:

"The offerer/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials to the maximum extent practicable, in accordance with paragraph 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR)".

4. Quality Assurance Requirements:

4.1 Contractor Certification. The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description, and that the product conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and therefore as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

4.2 Examination and Testing.

4.2.1 Suppliers are encouraged to use quality control (QC) techniques that exhibit control over their processes (e.g. (Statistical Process Control) SPC Techniques) as defined in American National Standards Institute (ANSI) Z1.1, Z1.2 and Z1.3 / American Society for Quality Control (ASQC) B.1, B.2 and B.3 that systematically reduce excess variations. If used, objective evidence shall be available that demonstrates overall measurement adequacy techniques and controls. These techniques shall ensure quality levels equal to, or greater than, those cited in applicable technical document or, herein.

4.2.2 End item inspection / testing may be used by the offeror or the Government representative, as a means to determine the effectiveness of the in process quality controls. In process controls shall not be substituted for end item performance testing.

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Not type specified.

4.2.3 For those characteristics for which there are no such controls, or for end item performance test, lot by lot sampling for inspection / test shall be required. The sample unit shall be one marker. Sampling shall be in accordance with the American National Standards Institute (ANSI) / American Society for Quality Control (ASQC) Z1.4, Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

4.2.4 An inspection lot shall consist of all like items submitted for inspection at one time. The inspection level for sampling shall be S-3 with an AQL of 4.0 percent defective. The inspection level for visual, dimensional and performance characteristics testing shall be S-1 with an AQL of 6.5 percent defective. The supplier must provide objective evidence (tests and inspection records) that the presented material meets the requirements of the sampling plan as indicated above.

5. Performance Tests: Unless otherwise specified, the tests shall be conducted in an atmosphere of 21° ± 3°C (64.5°-75.2°F) and a relative humidity of 50% ± 5%. Tests involving writing, shall be conducted with the markers held at an angle approximately 55° ± 5° from the horizontal and with a writing pressure so that the markings are clearly visible. The write-out speed shall be set at 11 feet per minute, the marker capped (nib down) and allowed a 15 minute rest after each 9144cm (300 feet) segment. The initial point load shall be 100 grams and increased after each cycle. The write-out test shall continue until the marker has reached the minimum write-out distance. Test paper shall be in accordance with A-A-2804A, type III white bond paper having a pH of 5.0 with a basis weight of 60 grams per square meter (16 pound, 17 x 22 - 500). A tolerance of 5% is allowable. Paper for the Machine Writing Test shall have an additional requirement of 160-140 seconds maximum smoothness on both sides using the Sheffield method per the most current TAPPI T538 test method. Alternately, paper conforming to JCP-O-60 can be used as an alternate source.

5.1 Drying Time. Place a sheet of paper on a smooth, flat surface and partially cover with a second sheet of paper. Place a 200 gram weight, approximately 31.75 mm (1.25 inches) in diameter, on top of the second sheet. Write a five-letter word on the exposed portion of the bottom sheet, allow to dry five seconds, immediately draw the top sheet and the weight across the writing at a rate of approximately 101.6 mm (4.0 inches) per second. The writing shall not smear or smudge.

5.2 Startability. Write a five-letter word with an unused sample marker. Then place marker on its side with cap off for 30 minutes. Immediately draw the marker nib across a sheet of paper at a rate of 101.6 mm (4.0 inches) per second, increments of 203.32 mm (8 inches) until a solid, continuous mark of at lease 0.38 mm (0.015 inches) width is attained. Then place marker horizontally with cap off for an additional 15 hours and recap for 30 minutes. Remove the cap and draw the marker nib across the paper as described above and examine.

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5.3 Machine Write Test. The machine tests shall be conducted on a Anja model W-10A , Hartley model W10-F or Minitek writing test machines or equivalent capable of testing pens or refills, with the following parameters set:

Writing Load:	0.981 N **(100gF)** to 1.225N **(125gF)**
Writing Angle:	60 degrees to 90 degrees **(continuously varying)**
Writing Speed:	670 cm plus or minus 10.0 cm/in
Writing Pattern:	Ellipse

Select the marker tested and mount in writing position on the machine. Set the machine speed at 3352.8 mm (11 feet) per minute and the writing pressure at 50 grams. Operate the apparatus, stopping for a 15 minute recuperation period after each successive 91,440.3 mm (300 feet) of writing. Continue until the distance requirement is met or the marker fails to produce a solid continuous line 0.38 mm (0.015 inches) to 1.27 mm (0.05 inches).

6. Packaging:

6.1 Preservation, packing, and marking shall be specified in the contract or order.

7. Notes:

7.1 Applicable Documents. Issues of the following documents, in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

7.1.1 Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry (TAPPI): T479 method may be obtained from TAPPI, Technology Park, P.O. Box 105113, Atlanta, Georgia, 30348-5113.

7.1.2 Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington. DC 20402.

7.1.3 Application for copies of (ANSI) Z1.1, Z1.2 and Z1.3 and (ASQC) B.1, B.2 and B.3 may be obtained from the American Society for Quality Control. PO Box 3005, 611 E. Wisconsin Avenue, Milwaukee, WI 53201-4606.

7.1.4 JCP Specifications may be obtained from Chief Paper Procurement Section, MMPP, US Government Printing Office, North Capital and H Street, NW, Washington DC 20401.

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7.1 5 Ordering Information. Purchaser should select the required options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents.

A. Title, number, and date of this commercial item description.
B. Purchasers shall specify the color of ink required.
C. Purchasers shall specify arrangement for inspection and inspection facilities, if other than specified.
D. Purchasers shall specify packaging, packing, and any special marking for shipment, if other than required.
E. Purchasers shall specify identification marking, if other than required.
F. Purchasers shall specify if bar code marking is not required.
G. Purchasers should specify palletization, if required.

7.2 National Stock Number Listing.

Marker, Tube-Type, Fine Tip

7520-00-043-3408
7520-00-904-1265
7520-00-904-1266
7520-00-904-1267
7520-00-904-1268
7520-00-935-0979
7520-00-935-0980
7520-00-935-0981
7520-00-935-0982
7520-00-935-0983

MILITARY INTERESTS:
NONE: DoD has determined that no military activity has an interest in this commercial item description.

PREPARING ACTIVITY
GSA-FSS

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